

Affirmative action for ethnic minorities is another thing that we see in developed nations. We have affirmative action in the form of reservations, China has affirmative actions that ensures that all money acquired through taxation in these regions are spent towards the development of that region and is not sent to the central government. However, the way the Chinese government does this is also to be noted. Soviet Russia too had such affirmative action policies but that lead to the ethnic minorities gaining too much political influence and then began the fight to separate from the USSR. So the Chinese government has a researched affirmative action policy to prevent any economic disparity among the elected officials i.e., they don't make a lot of money and enjoy the high-life while their constituents suffer.

TOP-CLASS UNIVERSITIES

Speaking of education, a simple glance at The Guardian's Top 200 University rankings tells us that only three Indian institutions make their presence felt. In the case of China, that number swells up to seven. So they have more than twice the number of premier educational institutions as we do. All of which rank higher than ours. The United States, on the other hand, has 47 Universities in the list. A simple correlation tells us that having more of these institutes helps with the development of the nation.

Right now, we have a serious brain drain crisis wherein the most qualified talent leaves the country in search of better pastures. Compared to the country's population this is an insignificant number and that's because there are so few good institutes. When this number goes up, you have a much larger educated and skilled population. Since every country limits the number of immigrants it admits, not all of our brightest minds can leave. Essentially, instead of stemming the drain, we should be increasing the brain. For that to happen, we need to have more more institutions staffed with qualified lecturers who're trained to teach.

WHAT RESEARCH?

Another issue plaguing our system is

the lack of attention towards original research. College professors are hardly required to perform research and when they are supposed to publish papers, they take the easy way out. We at Digit receive many of such papers from professors, most of them are poorly written and often have just one source of information i.e. they are rewrites. Also, it doesn't help that we have an industry plagued with journals that have little-to-no peer-review process. One can simply write absolute garbage and get it published for a small fee. The situation is so bad that even the FTC (Federal Trade Commission) of the US filed an injunction against multiple such journals based in India.



If all that wasn't enough, then try taking your original research to your college authorities to get a patent. It's extremely likely that you will not get any credit at all. In fact, your professor might try to take credit for your work. Overseas, you do get credit for your work and if you have utilised any of your college's resources, then your college will lay claim to your work. In India, you're better off hiding your invention or research till you have graduated and then you should file a patent separately. This way you get author credit and can monetise your work.

One of the key requirements for research is the right hardware. Few universities in the country bother to have a well-equipped lab. The top universities such as the IITs do have good

labs and even GPU farms for parallel computing experiments. However, these farms often go unused or under-used because there is no qualified person to man the equipment. These GPU clusters or server farms often have proprietary software that need trained personnel who can help students take their experiments and build a model that can run on the systems. Since such ancillary positions are not given the same benefits as tenured positions are, the retention rate is extremely low.

MAKING IN INDIA

The government's initiative to promote manufacturers to build in India is a well-thought initiative. Building a

nation's export markets are always helpful to accelerate economic growth, however, if we look at what manufacturers are doing right now, it's not quite "making" but mostly "assembling." When we're assembling, we aren't helping our export markets to its full potential since the stuff we assemble is being imported from some other country. Since companies like Apple and Samsung have now set up massive manufacturing plants in our country, we might as well build silicon fabs to help produce the SoCs that these companies need to build their products.

We've taken a lot of important steps in these last couple of years towards bettering our nation, let's hope and strive towards ensuring it stays on that path regardless of which government comes to power. 